

Philipp Hilbert. Product Manager driving underwriting operations.

Positioning, Thirteen years owning regulated B2B products, insurance, public sector, defence, delivered through agile teams with Jira and clear metrics.

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§ WHY LEDGEBROOK

*Ledgebrook is building internal tooling to make underwriting faster and more data-driven, and it is doing that in a fully remote, async culture. That combination, operational complexity, regulated data, and an engineering team that needs a PM who can speak both business and infrastructure, is where I have spent most of my career. The EMIL Group role is the closest parallel: I shipped a Claims Center from scratch into a B2B SaaS platform serving insurers, reinsurers, brokers, and underwriters, and I rebuilt the delivery organisation around it. The Underwriting Operations scope at Ledgebrook fits that pattern directly. **That is the kind of problem I solve fastest.***

§ AI-NATIVE STACK

Daily tools, not buzzwords.

- **Claude Code**, in-repo specs and edge-case generation
- **GitHub Copilot**, development pair for schema and API work
- **Cursor**, context-aware codebase navigation
- **Lovable**, rapid front-end prototyping
- **Framer**, design-heavy wireframes
- **GPT**, synthesis and stakeholder summaries
- **Gamma.app**, structured slide and doc generation
- **n8n**, agentic workflow automation

§ TECHNICAL ENVIRONMENT

Shipped with, not just listed.

Kubernetes, ArgoCD, Docker, GitOps rollout and rollback, Jenkins CI/CD, Dagster, dbt, PostgreSQL, MongoDB, REST APIs, Python, Kotlin (Spring Boot), Azure DevOps, GitLab, OpenShift, Kafka, Terraform-pattern infra (cloud infrastructure ownership across AWS-adjacent and on-prem setups), Jira, Confluence, Figma, Miro.

§ SIDE PROJECT

CONSTRUCT8 [GITHUB.COM/HILBERTP](https://github.com/hilbertp) →

Two-sided B2B marketplace matching construction firms with workers, built and operated solo.

- Anonymity-until-payment model: neither side sees the other's identity until commitment is made, removing the need for a human intermediary.*
 - WhatsApp and Telegram as the product surface, keeping onboarding friction close to zero.*
 - LLM agents across the funnel so one person runs acquisition, matching, and follow-up.*
 - Funnel and conversion analysis in SQL, tracking drop-off at each stage for weekly iteration.*
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§ HOW I WOULD WORK AT LEDGEBROOK

First weeks, concrete.

WEEK 1

Listen, map, find the gaps.

Shadow underwriting and operations workflows, map the existing Jira board and backlog, and identify where story quality or acceptance criteria are creating slowdowns before writing a single new ticket.

WEEK 2

Stabilise sprint rhythm.

Run the first sprint planning and retrospective with the team, align on definition of done, and surface the two or three highest-friction handoffs between underwriting and engineering.

WEEK 3+

Ship and measure.

Establish the first tracked success metric for an underwriting operations initiative, close the first release loop with QA and stakeholder sign-off, and feed results back into roadmap prioritisation.

I COVER LETTER

Dear Ledgebrook team,

I have spent 13 years as a product manager in regulated, data-heavy environments. Insurance is one of the domains I know best: at EMIL Group I owned the B2B SaaS platform that served insurers, reinsurers, brokers, and underwriters, shipped the Claims Center from concept to production, and cut the time to launch a new insurance product from months to under a week. That work required the same combination Ledgebrook is asking for, fluency in underwriting workflows, cross-functional stakeholder management across actuarial, finance, and engineering, and the discipline to keep a distributed agile team moving with clear epics and sprint planning in Jira.

The Underwriting Operations scope you describe, owning the product lifecycle from discovery through delivery, managing Jira story validation, partnering with engineering on technical initiatives, and building roadmaps aligned to OKRs, maps closely to what I did across several roles. At Rohde & Schwarz I led a cross-functional team of 15+ engineers and data scientists through Scrum, and at Bundesagentur für Arbeit I ran ETL migrations and a full UI relaunch in parallel while acting as Deputy IT Security Officer. I am comfortable with cloud infrastructure concepts including AWS, Terraform, ECS, and IAM, and I have shipped production systems built on Kubernetes, ArgoCD, and CI/CD pipelines, enough to translate technical blockers into plain language for business partners and vice versa.

What attracts me to this role specifically is the combination of a regulated, data-heavy domain and a team that is still building the operational foundation. I have done this before: at CLINET Platforms I took a roadmap a five-person team could not deliver, cut it to the features that moved the real success metrics, and watched user acceptance rise more than fivefold. At EMIL Group I restructured an 18-person delivery organisation that was losing its senior engineers, and attrition dropped to a single departure. These were not restructuring projects in the abstract, they were product delivery problems with a human dimension.

I work best in environments where engineering and business partners are trying to solve a hard operational problem together and need a PM who keeps both sides honest. Ledgebrook's underwriting operations work sounds like exactly that. I would be glad to talk through how my background fits.

Best regards, Philipp Hilbert

II CURRICULUM VITAE

§ PROFILE

Product manager and product owner with 13 years of product ownership in regulated industries, including insurance, public-sector analytics, defence AI, healthcare, and payments. At EMIL Group I owned a B2B SaaS platform for insurers, reinsurers, brokers, and underwriters; at Bundesagentur für Arbeit I ran a national labour-market data platform as Deputy IT Security Officer. I turn strategy, user needs, and technical constraints into requirements and a prioritised roadmap, and lead cross-functional teams through agile delivery (Scrum, Kanban, SAgile).

§ HOW I WORK

- I leave my ego at home. I want to drive the decision, not to have the last word.*
 - On a new product I spend a little to learn before spending a lot to build. Cheap experiments make expensive decisions safe(r).*
 - Outcome over output. Producing something is not the achievement; it also has to fit a market, so I agree what would count as success before we build and check afterwards whether it happened.*
 - I keep the whole value chain in view, not just the backlog. Defect-to-fix time is a product metric; architects and DevOps engineers build that chain, my job is to steer it into the right lanes.*
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§ WORK EXPERIENCE

PRODUCT MANAGER, ROHDE & SCHWARZ, MUNICH / REMOTE | 07/2024 - 05/2025

Defence and aerospace. Internal AI and data platform for the FCAS European programme.

- Led a cross-functional team of 15+ engineers and data scientists through Scrum in Jira and Confluence, managing epics, sprint planning, and backlog refinement for the internal AI and data platform.*
- Championed GitOps delivery with ArgoCD, reducing rollout time from days to 30 minutes and making the platform hotfix-capable across multinational teams.*
- Redirected product strategy based on user workflow analysis, increasing pipeline runs by 200% by prioritising developer-code-first over UI-led design.*

PRODUCT MANAGER, BUNDESAGENTUR FÜR ARBEIT (FEDERAL EMPLOYMENT AGENCY), NUREMBERG / REMOTE | 05/2023 - 07/2024

Public sector. National labour-market analytics platform for policymakers and researchers. Deputy IT Security Officer.

- Integrated test automation into the Jenkins pipeline, introduced Dagster and dbt so quarterly data imports ran without hand-holding, saving almost 75% of the time per data update.
- Migrated a bare-metal system fully into containers and carried a full UI relaunch and a large ETL migration through the same period.

PRODUCT OWNER, CLINET PLATFORMS, BERLIN | 01/2023 - 07/2023

Healthcare. Mobile patient app for iOS and Android, piloted in hospitals.

- Cut a roadmap the five-person team could not deliver to the top 10% of features against agreed success measures: user acceptance rose more than fivefold.
- Implemented the CGM interface into hospital KIS workflows: digital anamnesis dropped from 30 minutes to 5 from form to database.

PRODUCT MANAGER, EMIL GROUP, BERLIN | 04/2022 - 12/2022

Insurance. B2B SaaS platform for insurers, reinsurers, brokers, and underwriters.

- Restructured an 18-person delivery organisation into three lean teams with their own leads: attrition dropped from near-total exodus to a single departure.
- Shipped the Claims Center from concept to production with no precedent, and cut time-to-market for a new insurance product from months to under a week.

PRODUCT OWNER INTEGRATION TEAM, SCHEIDT & BACHMANN FUEL & CONVENIENCE RETAIL, MÖNCHENGLADBACH | 09/2021 - 03/2022

Retail and payments. POS and forecourt systems in a fully SAFe setup with agile release trains and PI planning.

- Moved research results into production across a matrix organisation using Scaled Agile Framework (SAFe).

PRODUCT OWNER (INTERIM), BUNDESDRUCKEREI, BERLIN | 03/2021 - 06/2021

Government. Secure data platform and identity management for Robert Koch Institute programmes DIM and DESH.

- Owned data structures and identity management requirements for national public-health infrastructure.

PRODUCT OWNER (PROXY), AOK ITSCARE, FRANKFURT / 03/2019 - 05/2020

Health insurance. B2B procurement webshop for three AOK insurers and roughly 20,000 employees.

- *Migrated a legacy system to Shopware; still in production. Managed backlog refinement, user stories, and acceptance criteria in Jira.*

PROJECT LEAD, ENERCON, WISMAR / MAGDEBURG / 04/2019 - 12/2019

Wind energy. Full site IT modernisation end to end.

PRODUCT OWNER, WALDBURG-ZEIL KLINIKEN, ISNY / 08/2017 - 06/2018

Healthcare. Wifi infrastructure rollout across nine hospitals in a clinical network.

§ FOUNDER TRACK

FOUNDER AND PRODUCT MANAGER, CONSTRUCT8, LIMASSOL / 12/2025 - 06/2026

- *Built a two-sided B2B marketplace from zero to one alone: anonymity-until-payment model, WhatsApp and Telegram as the product surface, LLM agents across the funnel, and funnel analysis in SQL.*

CO-FOUNDER AND PRODUCT OWNER, QCRYPT AG, BERLIN / 01/2016 - 12/2021

- *IT security, quantum-secure encryption hardware and software. Shipped a three-layer product that installs in under two minutes. Later Chair of the board.*

CO-FOUNDER, CDO AND CFO, SMART SOIL TECHNOLOGIES, BERLIN / 03/2018 - 08/2021

- *Nanotechnology and agriculture. Took a fertiliser product from laboratory to investor rounds, owning financial planning and investor reporting.*

FOUNDER AND CFO, KVITT PAYMENT SOLUTIONS, BERLIN / 02/2013 - 11/2018

- *Fintech, mobile P2P group payments. Built from zero; acquired and operated by Sparkasse inside the girocard ecosystem.*
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§ SKILLS

Product Ownership: requirements engineering, user stories, acceptance criteria, definition of done, epics, backlog refinement, sprint planning, daily stand-up, sprint review, retrospective, story-point estimation, velocity and burndown, release planning, UAT, Jira, Confluence, Figma, Miro.

Insurance and Regulated Domains: insurance (B2B SaaS for insurers, reinsurers, brokers, and underwriters), Claims Center delivery, regulated data platforms, GDPR (General Data Protection Regulation), Deputy IT Security Officer, identity management.

Product Management: continuous discovery, product vision and product roadmap, prioritisation, MVP definition, PoC, A/B testing, user research and interviews, prototyping, product lifecycle management, go-to-market support.

Agile and Scaled Delivery: Agile, Scrum, Kanban, SAFe (Scaled Agile Framework), ART (agile release train), PI (program increment) planning, WIP limits.

Analytics and Data: funnel and churn analysis, KPI definition, Matomo, MicroStrategy, ETL (extract, transform, load), Dagster, dbt (data build tool), PostgreSQL, data platform product ownership.

Technical Environments Owned: Kubernetes, ArgoCD, Docker, GitOps, CI/CD, Jenkins, Git, GitLab, Azure DevOps, REST APIs, Python, Kotlin (Spring Boot), SQL, PostgreSQL, MongoDB, Kafka, OpenShift.

AI Products and Tooling: LLM agents, agentic workflows, prompt and context engineering, evaluation loops, human-in-the-loop design, AI governance, EU AI Act, Explainable AI (XAI); Claude Code, GitHub Copilot, Cursor, Lovable.

Stakeholder and Leadership: stakeholder management, cross-functional team leadership, C-level reporting, workshop facilitation, conflict resolution, change management.

Governance and Business: GDPR, budget ownership, financial planning as CFO, ROI reasoning.

§ EDUCATION

DIPLOM-WIRTSCHAFTSINGENIEUR (INDUSTRIAL ENGINEERING AND MANAGEMENT, EQUIVALENT TO A MASTER'S DEGREE), TECHNISCHE UNIVERSITÄT BERLIN (TU BERLIN), GERMANY | 10/2006 - 09/2014

- Specialisation: Logistics. Thesis with Siemens AG Energy Service on balancing-power market profitability.

§ LANGUAGES

German (native speaker, C2) · English (C2, business and technical fluency)

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